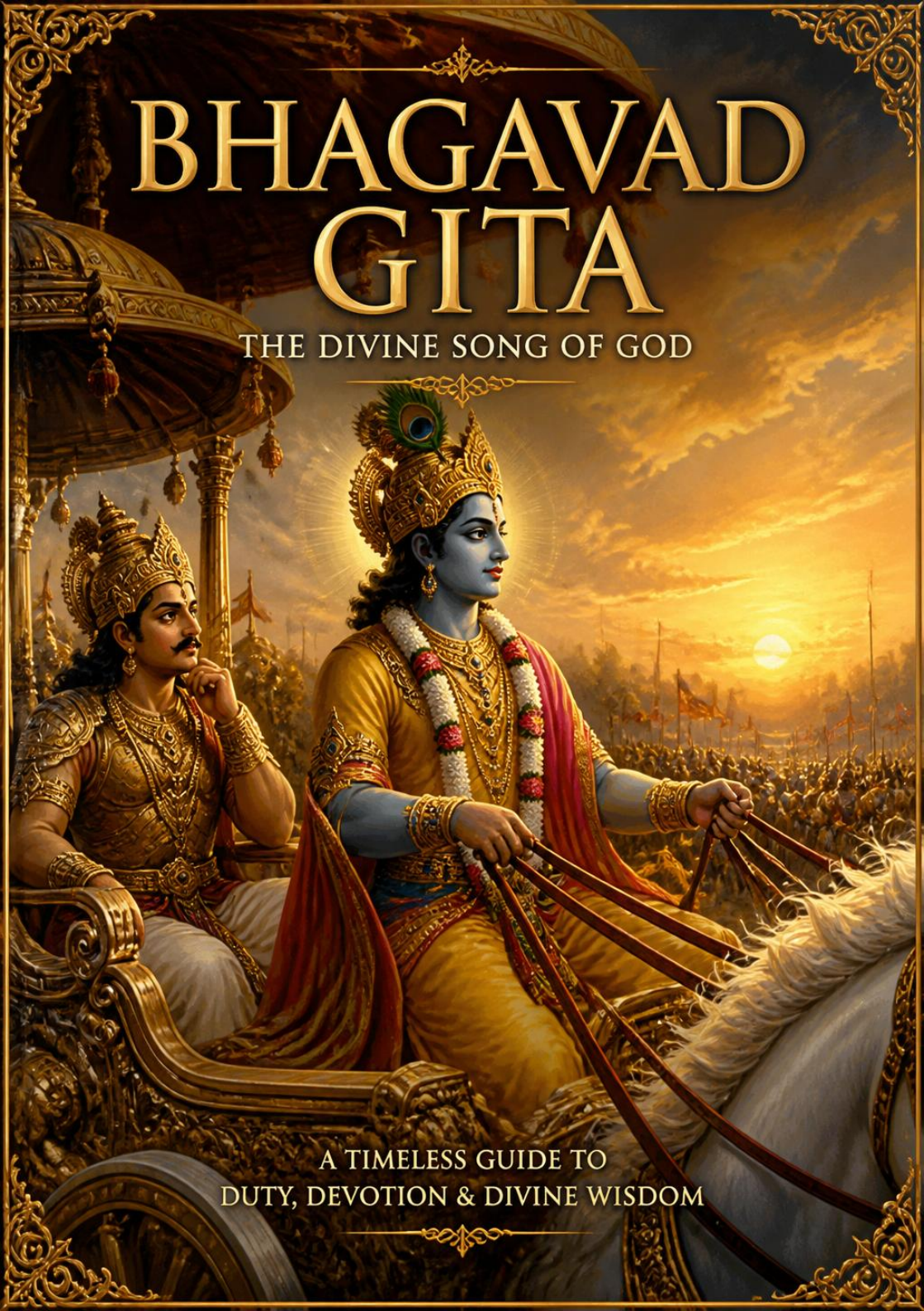


BHAGAVAD GITA

THE DIVINE SONG OF GOD



A TIMELESS GUIDE TO
DUTY, DEVOTION & DIVINE WISDOM

BHAGAVAD GITA

The Divine Song of God

॥ श्रीमद्भगवद्गीता ॥

A Timeless Guide to Duty, Devotion & Divine Wisdom

An Illustrated English Edition
with Sanskrit Shlokas in Devanagari

Compiled and Presented for Seekers Everywhere

॥ ॐ ॥

Dedicated to every seeker who stands, like Arjuna, at the crossroads of duty and doubt — may the words of the Blessed Lord illumine your path.

यत्र योगेश्वरः कृष्णो यत्र पार्थो धनुर्धरः।
तत्र श्रीर्वज्रियो भूतर्ध्रुवा नीतर्म्मत्तर्म्मम॥

Where there is Krishna, the Lord of Yoga, and Arjuna, the wielder of the bow — there, without doubt, will be prosperity, victory, well-being, and righteousness.

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Preface

॥ प्रस्तावना ॥

The Bhagavad Gita — literally, The Song of the Blessed Lord — is a scripture of seven hundred verses set within the sixth book of the Mahabharata. Though brief, it is regarded across the world as one of the most complete distillations of spiritual wisdom ever spoken. Emperors and philosophers, mystics and revolutionaries — Adi Shankara, Mahatma Gandhi, Aldous Huxley, Ralph Waldo Emerson, Albert Einstein — have all returned to its verses to steady the mind and clarify the heart.

This edition presents each of the eighteen chapters with its Sanskrit title, an introduction to its central teaching, and a selection of its most beloved verses. Every verse appears in the original Devanagari, followed by a Roman transliteration and a faithful English rendering. The aim is not scholarly exhaustiveness but living contact with the text — an invitation to sit, as Arjuna once did, at the feet of the Divine Charioteer and listen.

The Gita speaks to a moment we all know: the moment when duty and desire pull in opposite directions, when the mind trembles and the will grows weak. Its answer is not escape but engagement — action without attachment, devotion without self, knowledge without pride. May its light be yours.

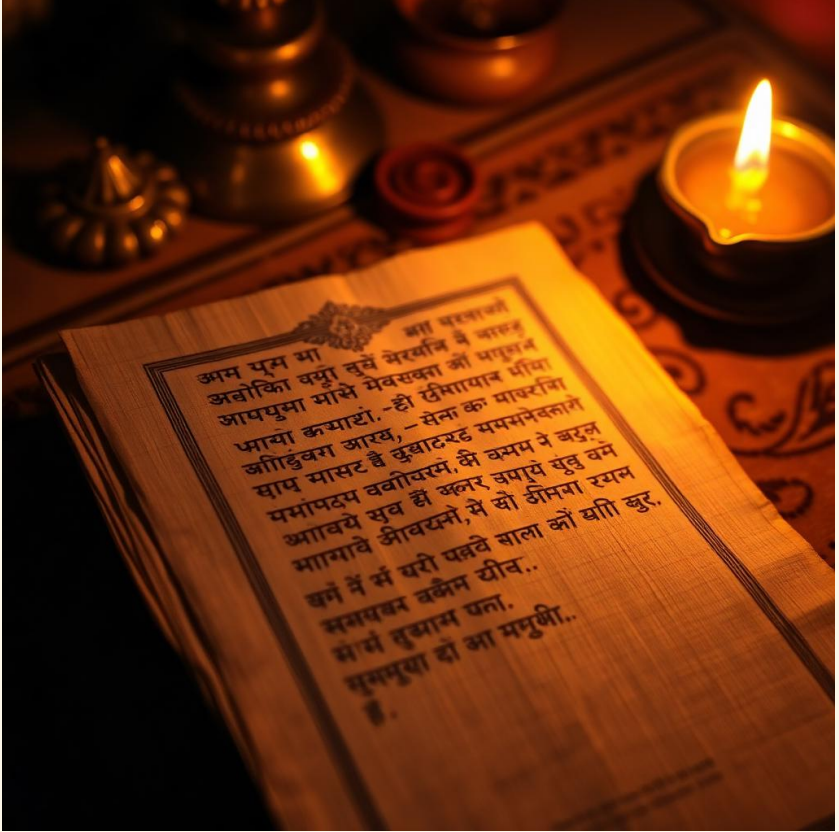
Introduction

The Setting of the Song

The Mahabharata is the tale of two branches of a single royal family — the noble Pandavas and their cousins the Kauravas — whose rivalry over the throne of Hastinapura ripens, across generations, into a war that will shake the world. When every embassy has failed and every compromise has been refused, the two armies gather on the sacred plain of Kurukshetra.

Among the Pandavas stands Arjuna, the greatest archer of the age. His charioteer is his cousin and dearest friend Krishna — who is also, though few yet perceive it, an incarnation of the Supreme. As the conches sound and the battle is about to begin, Arjuna asks Krishna to drive the chariot into the space between the armies so he may look upon those he must fight.

There, seeing grandfathers, teachers, uncles, cousins and childhood friends arrayed on both sides, his heart collapses. His bow slips from his hand. He sinks to the floor of the chariot and refuses to fight. It is at this moment — with two armies waiting, drums silent, and one man's soul in crisis — that Krishna begins to speak. What he says over the next eighteen chapters is the Bhagavad Gita.



“Wisdom preserved on palm-leaves, carried across three thousand years, from teacher to student, unbroken.”

The Four Paths

Chatur-Yoga

The Gita is often described as weaving together four great paths to the Divine — not as rivals, but as complementary currents of a single river. Each temperament may enter the ocean of realization by the path most natural to it.

Karma Yoga — the path of selfless action. Duty performed without craving for its fruit, offered to the Divine, purifies the mind and severs the root of bondage.

Bhakti Yoga — the path of loving devotion. The heart, poured out to the Beloved in every act and every breath, is lifted beyond fear and sorrow.

Jnana Yoga — the path of wisdom. Discrimination between the eternal Self and the changing world dissolves ignorance, the sole cause of suffering.

Dhyana Yoga — the path of meditation. Steady inward gathering of the mind reveals the Self as ever-present, ever-luminous, ever-free.

Krishna does not command us to choose one and reject the others. He teaches that action, devotion, wisdom, and meditation are inseparable — as light, warmth, brightness, and motion are inseparable in the sun.

Chapter 1

॥ अर्जुनवषादयोग ॥

Arjuna Vishada Yoga

The Yoga of Arjuna's Despair



Chapter 1 — Arjuna Vishada Yoga

The Teaching

The scene opens with the two armies drawn up on the plain of Kurukshetra. The blind king Dhritarashtra, listening from his palace, asks his minister Sanjaya to describe the field. Conches roar. Arjuna asks Krishna to place his chariot between the armies. Seeing the faces of his own kinsmen, teachers and friends arrayed for slaughter, Arjuna is overcome with grief and confusion. Casting aside his bow, he sinks down and refuses to fight — declaring that no kingdom, no pleasure, no life itself is worth the killing of those he loves. His despair is the seed from which the entire Gita will grow.

Reflection

Arjuna's collapse is not weakness — it is the sincerity of a noble soul face to face with the paradox of duty. The Gita begins where every honest spiritual life begins: not with certainty, but with a question the world cannot answer.

धर्मक्षेत्रे कुरुक्षेत्रे समवेता युयुत्सवः।

मामकाः पाण्डवाश्चैव कमिकुर्वत सञ्जय॥ १.१॥

*dharma-kṣetre kuru-kṣetre samavetā yuyutsavaḥ
māmakāḥ pāṇḍavāś caiva kim akurvata sañjaya*

Dhritarashtra said: O Sanjaya, gathered on the sacred field of Kurukshetra, eager for battle, what did my sons and the sons of Pandu do?

न च शक्नोम्यवस्थातुं भ्रमतीव च मे मनः।

नमित्तानि च पश्यामि विपरीतानि केशव॥ १.३०॥

*na ca śaknomy avasthātum bhramatīva ca me manaḥ
nimittāni ca paśyāmi viparītāni keśava*

I am unable to stand steady; my mind is whirling. I see only omens of evil, O Krishna.

न काङ्क्षे वजियं कृष्ण न च राज्यं सुखानिच।
कनो राज्येन गोवन्दि कभिगेरुजीवतिन वा॥ १.३२॥

*na kāṅkṣe vijayaṁ kṛṣṇa na ca rājyaṁ sukhāni ca
kiṁ no rājyena govinda kiṁ bhogair jīvitena vā*

I desire neither victory, O Krishna, nor kingdom, nor pleasures.
What use is a kingdom to us, Govinda? What use are
enjoyments, or even life itself?

Chapter 2

॥ साङ्ख्ययोग ॥

Sankhya Yoga

The Yoga of Knowledge

Chapter 2 — Sankhya Yoga

The Teaching

Chapter Two is called by many the heart of the Gita — for here Krishna, at last, begins to teach. He rebukes Arjuna's weakness, then rises into the great themes that the remaining chapters will unfold: the eternity of the Self, the imperishability of the soul, the meaning of duty, and the mystery of action performed without attachment. He introduces the ideal of the sthita-prajña — the sage of steady wisdom whose mind is undisturbed by pleasure or pain.

Reflection

To grieve for what is imperishable is ignorance; to act with equanimity, treating success and failure alike, is yoga. In these two sentences the Gita lays the foundation for everything that follows.

अशोच्यानन्वशोचस्त्वं प्रज्जावादांश्च भाषसे।
गतासूनगतासूंश्च नानुशोचन्तपिण्डिताः॥ २.११॥

*aśocyān anvaśocas tvaṁ prajñā-vādāṁś ca bhāṣase
gatāsūn agatāsūṁś ca nānuśocanti paṇḍitāḥ*

You grieve for those who should not be grieved for, yet speak words of wisdom. The wise mourn neither for the living nor for the dead.

नैनं छिन्दन्त शस्त्राणि नैनं दहति पावकः।
न चैनं क्लेदयन्त्यापो न शोषयति मारुतः॥ २.२३॥

*naiṁ chindanti śāstrāṇi naiṁ dahati pāvakaḥ
na cainaṁ kledayanty āpo na śoṣayati mārutaḥ*

Weapons cannot cleave the Self, fire cannot burn it, water cannot wet it, wind cannot dry it.

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि॥ २.४७॥

*karmany evādhikāras te mā phaleṣu kadācana
mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo 'stv akarmani*

You have the right to work, but never to the fruit of work. Do not let the fruits of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.

योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणासिङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनञ्जय।
सिद्ध्यसिद्धयोः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते॥ २.४८॥

*yoga-sthaḥ kuru karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā dhanañjaya
siddhy-asiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā samatvaṁ yoga ucyate*

Established in yoga, O Arjuna, perform your actions, casting off attachment and remaining even-minded in success and failure. This evenness of mind is called yoga.

Chapter 3

॥ कर्मयोग ॥

Karma Yoga

The Yoga of Action



Chapter 3 — Karma Yoga

The Teaching

Arjuna asks: if knowledge is superior to action, why urge him to a terrible deed? Krishna replies that no one can remain even for a moment without acting — even the body's breathing is action. The question is not whether to act, but how. Action performed as sacrifice (yajña), without craving for its fruit, sustains the world and purifies the doer. The Lord Himself, having nothing to gain, acts ceaselessly for the welfare of all.

Reflection

Renunciation is not the abandonment of action, but of attachment to its results. To work for the good of the whole is the highest form of freedom.

न हि किञ्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत्।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतजैर्गुणैः॥ ३.५॥

*na hi kaścit kṣaṇam api jātu tiṣṭhaty akarma-kṛt
kāryate hy avaśaḥ karma sarvaḥ prakṛti-jair guṇaiḥ*

No one can remain without acting even for a moment; everyone is helplessly driven to action by the qualities born of nature.

यज्जार्थात्कर्मणोऽन्यत्र लोकोऽयं कर्मबन्धनः।
तदर्थं कर्म कौन्तेय मुक्तसङ्गः समाचर॥ ३.९॥

*yajñārthāt karmaṇo 'nyatra loko 'yaṁ karma-bandhanaḥ
tad-arthaṁ karma kaunteya mukta-saṅgaḥ samācara*

Work done as sacrifice is free; all other work binds. Therefore, O Arjuna, perform every act as an offering, free from attachment.

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो वगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात्।
स्वधर्मे नधिनं श्रेयः परधर्मो भयावहः ॥ ३.३५॥

*śreyān sva-dharmo viguṇaḥ para-dharmāt sv-anuṣṭhitāt
sva-dharme nidhanam śreyaḥ para-dharmo bhayāvahaḥ*

Better one's own duty imperfectly done than another's duty well performed. Better to die in one's own dharma; another's dharma brings fear.

Chapter 4

॥ ज्ञानकर्मसन्न्यासयोग ॥

Jnana Karma Sanyasa Yoga

The Yoga of Knowledge & Renunciation of Action

Chapter 4 — Jnana Karma Sanyasa Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna reveals that this ancient yoga was first taught by Him to Vivasvan, the sun; that He is born age after age to restore righteousness; and that His birth and action are divine and unbound by karma. He praises knowledge as the fire that reduces all actions to ashes, and describes the true sage as one who sees action in inaction and inaction in action.

Reflection

The Divine takes form to teach, to protect, to lift. Right action becomes worship when performed with knowledge, and knowledge is the greatest of all purifiers.

यदा यदा ह्धिर्मस्य ग्लानर्भवति भारत ।
अभ्युत्थानमधर्मस्य तदात्मानं सृजाम्यहम् ॥ ४.७ ॥

*yadā yadā hi dharmasya glānir bhavati bhārata
abhyutthānam adharmasya tadātmānam sṛjāmy aham*

Whenever righteousness declines and unrighteousness rises, O Bharata, then I manifest Myself.

परतिराणाय साधूनां वनिशाय च दुष्कृताम् ।
धर्मसंस्थापनार्थाय सम्भवामि युगे युगे ॥ ४.८ ॥

*paritrāṇāya sādhūnām vināśāya ca duṣkṛtām
dharma-saṁsthāpanārthāya sambhavāmi yuge yuge*

To protect the good, to destroy the wicked, and to re-establish dharma, I take birth from age to age.

न हज्जिज्ञानेन सदृशं पवतिरमहि वदियते।
तत्स्वयं योगसंसिद्धिः कालेनात्मनविन्दति॥ ४.३८ ॥

*na hi jñānena sadṛśaṁ pavitram iha vidyate
tat svayaṁ yoga-saṁsiddhaḥ kālenātmani vindati*

There is nothing in this world so purifying as knowledge. In time, the one perfected in yoga finds it within the Self.

Chapter 5

॥ कर्मसन्न्यासयोग ॥

Karma Sanyasa Yoga

The Yoga of Renunciation

Chapter 5 — Karma Sanyasa Yoga

The Teaching

Arjuna asks whether renunciation of action or the yoga of action is better. Krishna answers that both lead to the same goal, but the yoga of action is the easier path. The true renunciate is not the one who abandons work, but the one who acts without desire, having offered every deed to Brahman.

Reflection

To renounce inwardly while working outwardly — this is the secret. The lotus lives in water yet is untouched by it.

ब्रह्मण्याधाय कर्माणि सिङ्गं त्यक्त्वा करोतयिः।

लपियते न स पापेन पद्मपत्रमविम्भसा ॥ ५.१० ॥

*brahmany ādhāya karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā karoti yaḥ
lipiyate na sa pāpena padma-patram ivāmbhasā*

One who offers all actions to Brahman, abandoning attachment, is untouched by sin, as a lotus leaf is untouched by water.

वदियावनियसम्पन्ने ब्राह्मणे गवहिस्तनिः।

शुनचैव श्वपाके च पण्डिताः समदर्शनिः ॥ ५.१८ ॥

*vidyā-vinaya-sampanne brāhmaṇe gavi hastini
śuni caiva śva-pāke ca paṇḍitāḥ sama-darśinaḥ*

The wise see with equal vision a learned brahmin, a cow, an elephant, a dog, and an outcast.

शान्तिर्निर्वाणपरमां मत्संस्थामधिगच्छति॥ ५.२९॥

śāntir nirvāṇa-paramām mat-samsthām adhigacchati

Such a one attains the supreme peace of liberation, established
in Me.

Chapter 6

॥ आत्मसंयमयोग ॥

Atma Samyama Yoga

The Yoga of Self-Control / Meditation



Chapter 6 — Atma Samyama Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna teaches the yoga of meditation. He describes the seat, the posture, the discipline of body and mind, and the qualities of the true yogi — even-minded toward friend and foe, self-restrained, seeing the Self in all beings and all beings in the Self. When Arjuna protests that the mind is more restless than the wind, Krishna replies with tender realism: yes — but by practice and dispassion, it can be tamed.

Reflection

Meditation is not escape from life but the deepening of it. The yogi is dear to Krishna who is undisturbed by the world and steady in the Self.

युक्ताहारवहिरस्य युक्तचेष्टस्य कर्मसु।
युक्तस्वप्नावबोधस्य योगो भवति दुःखहा॥ ६.१७॥

*yuktāhāra-vihārasya yukta-ceṣṭasya karmasu
yukta-svapnāvabodhasya yogo bhavati duḥkha-hā*

For one moderate in eating and recreation, balanced in action, temperate in sleep and waking — for such a one yoga becomes the destroyer of sorrow.

असंशयं महाबाहो मनो दुर्नग्रिहं चलम्।
अभ्यासेन तु कौन्तेय वैराग्येण च गृह्यते॥ ६.३५॥

*asaṁśayaṁ mahā-bāho mano durnigrahaṁ calam
abhyāseṇa tu kaunteya vairāgyeṇa ca grhyate*

Undoubtedly, O mighty-armed, the mind is restless and hard to restrain. But by practice and by dispassion, O Arjuna, it can be mastered.

योगनिमपि स्र्वेषां मदगतेनान्तरात्मना।
श्रद्धावान्भजते यो मां स मे युक्ततमो मतः॥ ६.४७॥

*yoginām api sarveṣāṁ mad-gatenāntar-ātmanā
śraddhāvān bhajate yo mām sa me yukta-tamo mataḥ*

Of all yogis, the one who worships Me with faith, whose inner self is absorbed in Me — that one is the most united with Me.

Chapter 7

॥ ज्ञानवज्ज्ञानयोग ॥

Jnana Vijnana Yoga

The Yoga of Wisdom & Realization

Chapter 7 — Jnana Vijnana Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna now begins to speak more directly of Himself. He is the origin and dissolution of all; nothing exists apart from Him. He describes the twofold nature — the higher spiritual and the lower material — and the four kinds of people who turn to Him: the distressed, the seeker of wealth, the seeker of knowledge, and the wise. The wise, He says, are dearest to Him.

Reflection

To know God is to see Him behind every appearance — the taste of water, the light of sun and moon, the strength of the strong, the intelligence of the intelligent.

मत्तः परतरं नान्यत्कञ्चिदस्ति धनञ्जय।
मयि सर्वमिदं प्रोतं सूत्रे मणिगणा इव ॥ ७.७ ॥

mattaḥ parataraṁ nānyat kiñcid asti dhanañjaya
mayi sarvam idaṁ protaṁ sūtre maṇi-gaṇā iva

There is nothing higher than Me, O Arjuna. All this universe is strung upon Me like pearls on a thread.

रसोऽहमप्सु कौन्तेय प्रभास्मि शिशूर्ययोः।
प्रणवः सर्ववेदेषु शब्दः खे पौरुषं नृषु ॥ ७.८ ॥

raso 'ham apsu kaunteya prabhāsmi śāsi-sūryayoḥ
praṇavaḥ sarva-vedeṣu śabdaḥ khe pauruṣaṁ nṛṣu

I am the taste in water, O Arjuna, the light of the sun and moon; I am the sacred syllable Om in all the Vedas, the sound in ether, the manhood in man.

दैवी ह्येषा गुणमयी मम माया दुरत्यया।
मामेव ये प्रपद्यन्ते मायामेतां तरन्ति॥ ७.१४॥

*daivī hy eṣā guṇa-mayī mama māyā duratyayā
mām eva ye prapadyante māyām etāṁ taranti te*

This divine illusion of Mine, composed of the qualities, is hard to overcome. But those who take refuge in Me alone cross beyond this maya.

Chapter 8

॥ अक्षरब्रह्मयोग ॥

Akshara Brahma Yoga

The Yoga of the Imperishable Brahman

Chapter 8 — Akshara Brahma Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna answers seven questions posed by Arjuna about Brahman, karma, and what happens at the moment of death. He teaches that whatever state of being one remembers at the end, that one attains — therefore one should remember the Lord at all times, and act accordingly. He speaks of the paths of light and shadow by which the departed travel, and the cycles of manifestation and dissolution that fill the vastness of cosmic time.

Reflection

Life is a rehearsal for the last moment. Live remembering, and you will die remembering — and be free.

अन्तकाले च मामेव स्मरन्मुक्त्वा कलेवरम्।
यः प्रयातसि मद्भावं यातनास्त्यत्र संशयः॥ ८.५॥

*anta-kāle ca mām eva smaran muktvā kalevaram
yaḥ prayāti sa mad-bhāvaṁ yāti nāsty atra saṁśayaḥ*

One who leaves the body at the time of death remembering Me alone attains My being — of this there is no doubt.

तस्मात्सर्वेषु कालेषु मामनुस्मर युध्य च।
मय्यर्पितमनोबुद्धिर्मामेवैष्यस्यसंशयम्॥ ८.७॥

*tasmāt sarveṣu kāleṣu mām anusmara yudhya ca
mayy arpita-mano-buddhir mām evaiṣyasy asaṁśayam*

Therefore at all times remember Me, and fight. With mind and intellect surrendered to Me, you shall come to Me without doubt.

ॐ इत्येकाक्षरं ब्रह्म व्याहरन्मामनुस्मरन्।
यः प्रयातति यजन् देहं स याति परमां गतिम्॥ ८.१३ ॥

*om ity ekākṣaram brahma vyāharan mām anusmaran
yaḥ prayāti tyajan dehaṁ sa yāti paramāṁ gatim*

Uttering the single syllable Om — Brahman — remembering
Me, one who departs from the body attains the supreme goal.

Chapter 9

॥ राजवदियाराजगुह्ययोग ॥

Raja Vidya Raja Guhya Yoga

The Yoga of the Royal Knowledge



Chapter 9 — Raja Vidya Raja Guhya Yoga

The Teaching

This chapter is called the most secret of secrets — the royal knowledge, the royal mystery. Krishna reveals His pervading, sustaining presence: the whole universe is strung on Him, all beings dwell in Him though He is not in them. He promises that even the most fallen, turning to Him with undivided devotion, is quickly transformed. Whatever is offered — a leaf, a flower, a fruit, water — He accepts if given with love.

Reflection

The Divine responds to devotion instantly. Nothing offered in love is small; nothing withheld is worthy.

मया ततमदिं सर्वं जगदव्यक्तमूर्तनि।
मत्स्थानसिखभूताननि चाहं तेष्ववस्थतिः॥ ९.४॥

*mayā tatam idaṁ sarvaṁ jagad avyakta-mūrtinā
mat-sthāni sarva-bhūtāni na cāhaṁ teṣv avasthitaḥ*

By Me, in My unmanifest form, this whole universe is pervaded. All beings dwell in Me, yet I am not in them.

पत्रं पुष्पं फलं तोयं यो मे भक्त्या प्रयच्छति
तदहं भक्त्युपहतमश्नामिप्रयतात्मनः॥ ९.२६॥

*patraṁ puṣpaṁ phalaṁ toyaṁ yo me bhaktyā prayacchati
tad ahaṁ bhakty-upahṛtam aśnāmi prayatātmanaḥ*

Whoever offers Me, with devotion, a leaf, a flower, a fruit, or water — that offering of love, from a pure heart, I accept.

अनन्याश्चन्तियन्तो मां ये जनाः पर्युपासते।
तेषां नित्याभयिक्तानां योगक्षेमं वहाम्यहम्॥ ९.२२॥

*ananyāś cintayanto mām ye janāḥ paryupāsate
teṣāṁ nityābhi-yuktānām yoga-kṣemaṁ vahāmy aham*

To those who worship Me alone, thinking of none other, ever united with Me — to them I bring what they lack and preserve what they have.

Chapter 10

॥ वभूतयोग ॥

Vibhuti Yoga

The Yoga of Divine Glories

Chapter 10 — Vibhuti Yoga

The Teaching

Arjuna asks Krishna to describe His divine glories. Krishna replies that His manifestations are endless, but names some: among the Adityas He is Vishnu; among stars, the moon; among mountains, Meru; among rivers, the Ganges; among weapons, the thunderbolt; among words, Om; among letters, the letter A. Whatever is glorious, beautiful, or powerful — know it to be a spark of His splendor.

Reflection

To glimpse divinity in the shining things of the world is to begin to see it everywhere. Wonder is the doorway of devotion.

अहमात्मा गुडाकेश सर्वभूताशयस्थितिः।

अहमादश्चि मध्यं च भूतानामन्त एव च॥ १०.२०॥

*aham ātmā guḍākeśa sarva-bhūtāśaya-sthitaḥ
aham ādiś ca madhyaṁ ca bhūtānām anta eva ca*

I am the Self, O Arjuna, seated in the hearts of all beings. I am the beginning, the middle, and the end of all creatures.

यद्यद्विभूतिमित्सत्त्वं श्रीमदूर्जतिमेव वा।

तत्तदेवावगच्छ त्वं मम तेजोऽशसम्भवम्॥ १०.४१॥

*yad yad vibhūti-mat sattvaṁ śrīmad ūrjitam eva vā
tat tad evāvagaccha tvaṁ mama tejo-'mśa-sambhavam*

Whatever is glorious, beautiful, or mighty — know it to be born of but a spark of My splendor.

वष्टिभ्याहमदिं कृत्स्नमेकांशेन स्थितिं जगत्॥ १०.४२॥

viṣṭabhyāham idaṁ kṛtsnam ekāṁśena sthito jagat

With but a single fragment of Myself I pervade and support
this entire universe.

Chapter 11

॥ वश्वरूपदर्शनयोग ॥

Vishvarupa Darshana Yoga

The Yoga of the Cosmic Vision



Chapter 11 — Vishvarupa Darshana Yoga

The Teaching

Arjuna, moved by Krishna's words, asks to behold the divine form directly. Krishna grants him divine sight — and Arjuna sees the whole universe within the body of the Lord: suns, moons, gods, sages, warriors, worlds, all pouring like rivers into the flaming mouths of Time. Overcome with terror and awe, he begs Krishna to return to His gentle human form. This is the most sublime and terrifying vision in all scripture.

Reflection

The universe itself is God's body. To see this is to be unmade — and then remade — in love.

दवि सूर्यसहस्रस्य भवेद्युगपदुत्थति।

यदभिः सदृशी सा स्याद्भासस्तस्य महात्मनः ॥ ११.१२ ॥

*divi sūrya-sahasrasya bhaved yugapad utthitā
yadi bhāṣi sadṛśī sā syād bhāsas tasya mahātmanaḥ*

If a thousand suns were to blaze forth together in the sky, that might resemble the splendor of that mighty Being.

कालोऽस्मि लोकक्षयकृत्प्रवृद्धो लोकान्समाहर्तुमहि प्रवृत्तः ॥

११.३२ ॥

kālo 'smi loka-kṣaya-kṛt pravṛddho lokān samāhartum iha pravṛttaḥ

I am mighty Time, the destroyer of worlds, come forth to annihilate all beings.

तस्मात्त्वमुत्तष्ठि यशो लभस्व जतिवा शत्रून्भुङ्क्स्व राज्यं
समृद्धम्।

मयैवैते नहिताः पूर्वमेव नमित्तिमात्रं भव सव्यसाचिन् ॥ ११.३३ ॥

*tasmāt tvam uttiṣṭha yaśo labhasva jtvā śatrūn bhuṅkṣva rājyaṁ
samṛddham*

mayaiwaite nihatāḥ pūrvam eva nimitta-mātraṁ bhava savya-sācin

Therefore arise and win glory. Conquering your foes, enjoy a prosperous kingdom. By Me these have already been slain — be you only the instrument, O Arjuna.

Chapter 12

॥ भक्तयोग ॥

Bhakti Yoga

The Yoga of Devotion



Chapter 12 — Bhakti Yoga

The Teaching

Arjuna asks which is better — to worship the personal Lord with form, or the imperishable unmanifest. Krishna replies that both attain Him, but the path of the unmanifest is harder for embodied beings. He then gives a luminous portrait of the true devotee: friendly and compassionate to all, free from possessiveness and ego, patient in suffering, unrelated by praise and unshaken by blame, ever content, self-controlled, dear to the Lord.

Reflection

Devotion is not a feeling but a life. The one whose heart lives in the Divine becomes divine.

मय्येव मन आधत्स्व मयिबुद्धिं निविश।
नविसर्षियसि मय्येव अत ऊर्ध्वं न संशयः॥ १२.८॥

*mayy eva mana ādhatsva mayi buddhiṁ niveśaya
nivasisyasi mayy eva ata ūrdhvaṁ na saṁśayaḥ*

Fix your mind on Me alone; let your intellect abide in Me.
Then, without doubt, you shall live in Me hereafter.

अद्वेष्टा सर्वभूतानां मैत्रः करुण एव च।
नर्ममो नरिहङ्कारः समदुःखसुखः क्षमी॥ १२.१३॥

*adveṣṭā sarva-bhūtānāṁ maitraḥ karuṇa eva ca
nirmamo nirahaṅkāraḥ sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ kṣamī*

One who hates no creature, who is friendly and compassionate
to all, free from possessiveness and egoism, balanced in joy
and sorrow, and forgiving — such a devotee is dear to Me.

यो न हृष्यति न द्वेष्टति न शोचति न काङ्क्षति
शुभाशुभपरित्यागी भक्तमिन्ः स मे प्रियः॥ १२.१७॥

yo na hr̥syati na dveṣṭi na śocati na kāṅkṣati
śubhāśubha-parityāgī bhaktimān yaḥ sa me priyaḥ

One who neither rejoices nor hates, neither grieves nor desires, who has renounced both good and evil, and who is full of devotion — that one is dear to Me.

Chapter 13

॥ क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञवभिगयोग ॥

**Kshetra Kshetrajna Vibhaga
Yoga**

The Field & the Knower of the Field

Chapter 13 — Kshetra Kshetrajna Vibhaga Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna distinguishes the kshetra — the field, which is the body and all its contents — from the kshetrajna — the knower of the field, which is the Self, and ultimately the Lord Himself. He describes true knowledge as humility, non-injury, self-restraint, evenness, and constant devotion. To see the imperishable Self in every perishable form is to see truly.

Reflection

You are not what changes. You are the silent witness in whose light all change is seen.

क्षेत्रज्ञं चापि मां विद्धि सर्वक्षेत्रेषु भारत।
क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञयोर्ज्ञानं यत्तज्ज्ञानं मतं मम॥ १३.२॥

kṣetra-jñāṁ cāpi māṁ viddhi sarva-kṣetreṣu bhārata
kṣetra-kṣetra-jñāyor jñānaṁ yat taj jñānaṁ mataṁ mama

Know Me to be the Knower of the field in every field, O Arjuna.
Knowledge of both the field and its Knower — this I hold to be
true knowledge.

समं सर्वेषु भूतेषु तिष्ठन्तं परमेश्वरम्।
वनिश्यत्स्ववनिश्यन्तं यः पश्यतसि पश्यति॥ १३.२८॥

samaṁ sarveṣu bhūteṣu tiṣṭhantaṁ parameśvaram
vinaśyatsv avinaśyantaṁ yaḥ paśyati sa paśyati

One who sees the Supreme Lord dwelling equally in all beings
— imperishable within the perishing — truly sees.

यथा प्रकाशयत्येकः कृत्स्नं लोकमग्निं रविः।
क्षेत्रं क्षेत्री तथा कृत्स्नं प्रकाशयति भारत ॥ १३.३४ ॥

*yathā prakāśayaty ekaḥ kṛtsnaṁ lokam imañ raviḥ
kṣetraṁ kṣetrī tathā kṛtsnaṁ prakāśayati bhārata*

As the one sun illumines the whole world, so the Knower of the field illumines the entire field, O Arjuna.

Chapter 14

॥ गुणत्रयवभिगयोग ॥

Gunatraya Vibhaga Yoga

The Three Modes of Nature

Chapter 14 — Gunatraya Vibhaga Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna explains the three gunas — sattva (harmony, light), rajas (activity, passion), and tamas (inertia, darkness) — which weave together to form the whole of nature and bind the soul. He describes their signs, their fruits, and the way of transcending them. The one who is unmoved by their play, established in the Self, is called gunatita — beyond the modes.

Reflection

To watch the qualities of nature act upon themselves — without identifying with them — is freedom.

सत्त्वं सुखे सञ्जयतरिजः कर्मणिभारत।

ज्ञानमावृत्य तु तमः प्रमादे सञ्जयत्युत॥ १४.९॥

*sattvaṁ sukhe sañjayati rajaḥ karmaṇi bhārata
jñānam āvṛtya tu tamaḥ pramāde sañjayaty uta*

Sattva binds one to happiness, rajas to action, and tamas, veiling knowledge, binds one to negligence.

मां च योऽव्यभचिरेण भक्तियोगेन सेवते।

स गुणान्समतीत्यैतान्ब्रह्मभूयाय कल्पते॥ १४.२६॥

*māṁ ca yo 'vyabhicāreṇa bhakti-yogena sevate
sa guṇān samatītyaitān brahma-bhūyāya kalpate*

One who serves Me with unwavering devotion transcends these qualities and becomes fit for oneness with Brahman.

समदुःखसुखः स्वस्थः समलोष्टाश्मकाञ्चनः ।
तुल्यप्रियाप्रियो धीरस्तुल्यनन्दितात्मसंस्तुतिः ॥ १४.२४ ॥

*sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ svasthaḥ sama-loṣṭāśma-kāñcanaḥ
tulya-priyāpriyo dhīras tulya-nindātma-saṁstutiḥ*

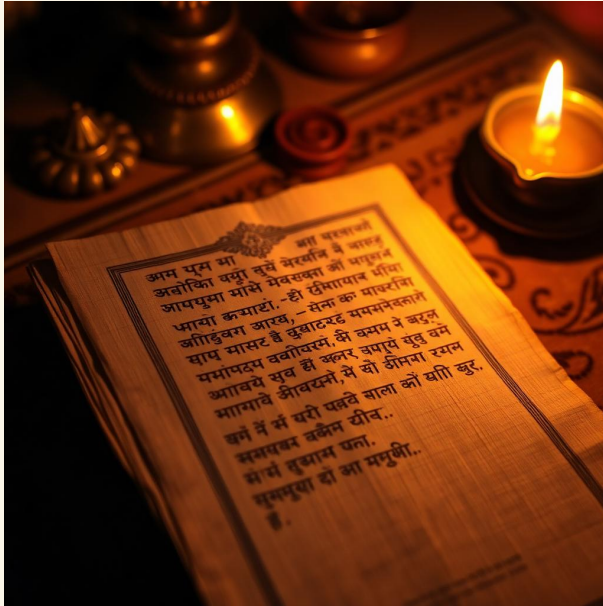
Balanced in pain and pleasure, self-abiding, viewing a clod, a stone, and gold alike, the same toward pleasant and unpleasant, firm, the same in blame and praise — such a one has transcended the modes.

Chapter 15

॥ पुरुषोत्तमयोग ॥

Purushottama Yoga

The Yoga of the Supreme Person



Chapter 15 — Purushottama Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna uses the ancient image of the ashvattha — the eternal tree with roots above and branches below — to describe the manifest universe, whose true root is Brahman. He teaches that a fragment of Himself, becoming the eternal jiva, enters into every being. He is the light in sun, moon, and fire; the fire of digestion in every body; the memory, knowledge, and reason in every heart. He is the Supreme Person — greater than the perishable and the imperishable both.

Reflection

Cut the tree of illusion with the axe of non-attachment; find its root in the Eternal.

ऊर्ध्वमूलमधःशाखमश्वत्थं प्राहुरव्ययम्।
छन्दांसयिष्य पर्णानयिस्तं वेद स वेदवत्॥ १५.१॥

*ūrdhva-mūlam adhaḥ-śākham aśvatthaṁ prāhur avyayam
chandāṁsi yasya parṇāni yas taṁ veda sa veda-vit*

They speak of an imperishable ashvattha tree, its roots above, its branches below, whose leaves are the sacred hymns. One who knows it, knows the Veda.

मामेव ये प्रपद्यन्ते मायामेतां तरन्ति॥ १५.६॥

mām eva ye prapadyante māyām etāṁ taranti te

Those who reach Me — to that supreme abode — do not return to this world of sorrow.

ममैवांशो जीवलोके जीवभूतः सनातनः ॥ १५.७ ॥

mamaivāṁśo jīva-loke jīva-bhūtaḥ sanātanaḥ

An eternal fragment of My own Self, having become the living soul in this world of the living, draws to itself the senses and mind that abide in nature.

Chapter 16

॥ दैवासुरसम्पद्विभागयोग ॥

**Daivasura Sampad Vibhaga
Yoga**

The Divine & Demoniatic Natures

Chapter 16 — Daivasura Sampad Vibhaga Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna contrasts two natures found among humans: the daivi sampad — divine endowment: fearlessness, purity, self-control, non-injury, truthfulness, freedom from anger, compassion, gentleness, modesty, steadiness; and the asuri sampad — demoniac endowment: hypocrisy, arrogance, conceit, harshness, ignorance. The one leads to liberation, the other to bondage. Three gates open to hell — lust, anger, and greed — and the wise abandon them.

Reflection

Character is destiny. Cultivate the qualities of the divine, and the divine becomes your home.

अभयं सत्त्वसंशुद्धिर्ज्ञानयोगव्यवस्थितिः।

दानं दमश्च यज्जश्च स्वाध्यायस्तप आर्जवम्॥ १६.१॥

*abhayaṁ sattva-saṁśuddhir jñāna-yoga-vyavasthitiḥ
dānaṁ damaś ca yajñāś ca svādhyāyas tapa ārjavam*

Fearlessness, purity of heart, steadfastness in the yoga of knowledge, charity, self-control, sacrifice, study of scripture, austerity, and uprightness —

अहंसा सत्यमक्रोधस्त्यागः शान्तरिपैशुनम्।

दया भूतेष्वलोलुप्त्वं मार्दवं ह्रीरचापलम्॥ १६.२॥

*ahimsā satyam akrodhas tyāgaḥ śāntir apaiśunam
dayā bhūteṣv aloluptvaṁ mārdaṁ hrīr acāpalam*

Non-violence, truth, freedom from anger, renunciation, tranquility, absence of slander, compassion for all beings, freedom from covetousness, gentleness, modesty, and steadiness —

त्रिविधिं नरकस्येदं द्वारं नाशनमात्मनः।

कामः क्रोधस्तथा लोभस्तस्मादेतत्त्रयं त्यजेत्॥ १६.२१॥

*tri-vidhaṁ narakasyedaṁ dvāraṁ nāśanam ātmanaḥ
kāmaḥ krodhas tathā lobhas tasmād etat trayam tyajet*

Threefold is the gate of hell, ruinous to the soul — lust, anger, and greed. Therefore let one abandon these three.

Chapter 17

॥ श्रद्धात्रयवभागयोग ॥

Shraddhatraya Vibhaga Yoga

The Three Kinds of Faith

Chapter 17 — Shraddhatraya Vibhaga Yoga

The Teaching

Krishna teaches that faith, food, worship, austerity, and charity are each of three kinds, corresponding to the three modes of nature. Sattvic faith seeks the truth; rajasic faith seeks power and pleasure; tamasic faith clings to fear and superstition. He gives the mantra Om Tat Sat — the threefold designation of Brahman by which every sacred action is sanctified.

Reflection

What a person believes, that they become. Cultivate luminous faith and every act becomes worship.

सत्त्वानुरूपा सर्वस्य श्रद्धा भवति भारत।
श्रद्धामयोऽयं पुरुषो यो यच्छ्रद्धः स एव सः॥ १७.३॥

sattvānurūpā sarvasya śraddhā bhavati bhārata
śraddhā-mayo 'yaṁ puruṣo yo yac-chraddhaḥ sa eva saḥ

The faith of each is shaped by their nature, O Arjuna. A person is made of faith — as their faith is, so are they.

देवद्विजिगुरुप्राज्ञपूजनं शौचमार्जवम्।
ब्रह्मचर्यमहिसा च शारीरं तप उच्यते॥ १७.१४॥

deva-dvija-guru-prājña-pūjanaṁ śaucam ārjavam
brahmacaryam ahiṁsā ca śārīraṁ tapa ucyate

Reverence toward the divine, the wise, the teacher, and the learned; purity, uprightness, chastity, and non-injury — these are the austerities of the body.

ॐ तत्सदति निर्देशो ब्रह्मणस्त्रविधिः स्मृतः ॥ १७.२३ ॥

om tat sad iti nirdeśo brahmaṇas tri-vidhaḥ smṛtaḥ

Om, Tat, Sat — this is the threefold designation of Brahman.

Chapter 18

॥ मोक्षसन्न्यासयोग ॥

Moksha Sanyasa Yoga

The Yoga of Liberation

Chapter 18 — Moksha Sanyasa Yoga

The Teaching

The longest chapter draws together every thread. Krishna distinguishes sannyasa (renunciation of desire-driven action) from tyaga (renunciation of attachment to the fruits of action), and again reviews the three modes as they color knowledge, action, doer, intellect, resolve, and happiness. At the summit, He gives the supreme instruction — the most secret of all: Abandon all dharmas, take refuge in Me alone; I will liberate you from all sins, do not grieve. Arjuna's confusion is dispelled; he takes up his bow again. Sanjaya, having witnessed it all, closes the Gita with a blessing.

Reflection

The end of the teaching is surrender. Where reason falters, love completes. The song ends where every song ends — in silence, and in the presence of the Beloved.

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात्।
स्वभावनयितं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम्॥ १८.४७॥

*śreyān sva-dharmo viguṇaḥ para-dharmāt sv-anuṣṭhitāt
svabhāva-niyataṁ karma kurvan nāpnoti kilbiṣam*

Better one's own dharma imperfectly done than another's done well. Performing the work born of one's own nature, one incurs no sin.

सर्वधर्मान्परित्यज्य मामेकं शरणं व्रज।
अहं त्वा सर्वपापेभ्यो मोक्षयिष्यामि मा शुचः॥ १८.६६॥

*sarva-dharmān parityajya mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja
ahaṁ tvā sarva-pāpebhyo mokṣayiṣyāmi mā śucaḥ*

Abandon all dharmas and take refuge in Me alone. I shall liberate you from all sins — grieve not.

यत् योर्गेश्वरः कृष्णो यत् पार्थो धनुर्धरः।
तत् श्रीर्वज्रियो भूतर्ध्रुवा नीतर्मितर्मम ॥ १८.७८ ॥

yatra yogeśvaraḥ kṛṣṇo yatra pārtho dhanur-dharaḥ
tatra śrīr vijayo bhūtir dhruvā nītir matir mama

Wherever there is Krishna, the Lord of Yoga, and Arjuna, the wielder of the bow — there, surely, are prosperity, victory, well-being, and firm righteousness. This is my conviction.

॥ इति श्रीमद्भगवद्गीता समाप्ता ॥

Thus concludes the Srimad Bhagavad Gita

ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

Om — Peace, Peace, Peace

*May the reading of this song bring peace to all beings,
everywhere.*